

IBM 64MB USB 2.0 Memory Key

Big Blue's data key chain

IBM was the first to introduce high-capacity micro drives. With the popularisation of flash memories, IBM has made its presence felt with USB key-drives that are available in capacities ranging from 64 MB to 256 MB. The



accessories bundled with the drives comprise a small leather pouch, a neck sling and a clip attached with the cap. The 64MB USB 2.0 Memory Key drive sports a translucent black body with a small LED to indicate the drive status. The drive is automatically detected in Windows 2000, Me and XP, and the drivers required for Windows 98 and NT are provided in the bundled CD.

Price: Rs 4,500
Contact: IBM
Phone: 080-2063000
080-2063702
E-mail: bvasudev@in.ibm.com
Web site: www.ibm.com

The LED blinks when data is transferred, and the bundled encryption software helps protect your data.

We were able to transfer 54 MB of data from the drive in just 42 seconds. The drive is priced at Rs 4,500, which is quite expensive—the same capacity iOmega drive is priced around Rs 3,200. Overall, it is a product with good looks, but over priced. If you want the fastest drive available, and cost isn't a factor, we recommend this drive.

SPECIFICATIONS

64 MB and 256 MB capacities available, Compatible with USB 1.1 and 2.0, Weight 15 g, Drivers for Windows 98 and Windows NT 4.0 provided.

IBM 64MB USB 2.0 Memory Key B+	
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶

Microsoft Wireless Optical Desktop Elite

Black pearl

Microsoft input devices have always being a delight to use, and the latest Wireless Optical Desktop Elite keyboard-mouse combination is no exception.

The black and silver grey keyboard is studded with translucent buttons. The characters are etched in white over the translucent black keys producing an excellent contrast for viewing. The multimedia keys are placed on the top of the keyboard, and a small Internet scroll



wheel with Back and Forward buttons on the extreme left. The scroll wheel allows vertical as well as horizontal scrolling. The keyboard comes with nine pre-defined keys for instant access to pre-defined folders. It also has eight multimedia keys for volume control and playing a CD. It also has five programmable keys, that you can use to quickly launch your favourite programs.

This keyboard has a soft palm rest with a smooth leather finish, for extreme comfort. The button layout is perfectly contoured with respect to the palm rest, giv-

ing you a perfect typing angle for stress-free usage.

The mouse comes with Microsoft's new Tilt technology that allows scrolling in both horizontal and vertical directions. It is uni-dextrously designed for right-handed people, with contoured grooves. The mouse has the normal three buttons as well as two extra buttons, all of which are programmable. The scroll wheel is too smooth, and lacks tactile feel. The mouse is extremely precise and is not

Price: Rs 7,250
Contact: Microsoft Connect
Phone: 1600-1111-00
Web site: www.microsoft.com/india/connect

plagued with a line of sight problem due to the use of radio frequency. The combination requires five AA batteries.

At Rs 7,250, it's a great product for your desktop if you can afford the price.

SYSTEM REQUIREMENTS

Windows 2000 or XP (for using the tilt wheel), 128 MB of RAM, Pentium 133 MHz or above, 60 MB of disk space and PS/2 ports for the combination

Microsoft Wireless Optical Desktop Elite B	
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶
Ergonomics	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶

Sony SDM HS53 LCD Monitor

High on performance, low on features

The Sony SDM HS53 is an extremely good looking 15-inch LCD monitor. It weighs only 3.8 Kg and lacks in-built speakers. It has an intuitive on-screen display, but the buttons are inconveniently placed below the front panel.

We ran a couple of tests to check its sharpness, colour reproduction and various other properties. To our surprise, it performed extremely well on almost all the tests. The images were sharp and barring a little bit of colour streaks, It showed very little ghosting. The screen showed uniform brightness throughout; even though it supported only 60 Hz at a resolution of 1024 x 768, we found no flickering. The only negative point, is its mild reflective

nature—it was difficult to view dark scenes.

It ships with a user guide and a utility CD, but no drivers. It supports only analog connectivity, and an analog data cable is provided. It has a wide viewable angle, and can be comfortably positioned.

At Rs 31,500, one expects more features such as in-built speakers, height adjustment, etc. Overall, this monitor loses out on value for money and features.

SPECIFICATIONS

15-inch LCD monitor, maximum resolution of 1024 x 768 at 60 Hz, 0.297 dot pitch, 3.8 Kgs weight.

Price: Rs 31,500
Contact: Rashi Peripherals
Phone: 022-28260258
Fax: 022-28221012
E-mail: ho@rptechindia.com
Web site: www.rptechindia.com

Sony SDM HS53 LCD Monitor B+	
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶
Build Quality	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶